



SURVEY SHARK

Field Collector Guide

For student researchers collecting survey responses

For students collecting data for a research unit fieldwork exercise.
Keep this guide with you (or saved on your phone) during data collection.

Fill this in before you go to the field

Web address to open	
Access code	
My Student Researcher ID	
Supervisor contact	

Ask your supervisor for these before your first day of fieldwork.

1. What is Survey Shark?

Survey Shark is the app you'll use on your phone to enter each participant's survey answers while you're out doing fieldwork. It replaces a paper questionnaire — it asks the same questions, in the same order, and works even when you have no internet signal.

Why it works without signal

Once you've opened the app one time with data or wifi, it keeps working with no signal at all. Answers you enter are saved on your phone first, then sent to the research team automatically the next time you have a connection — you don't need to do anything for this to happen.

2. Before you go out

Make sure you have:

- Your **Student Researcher ID** (given to you by your supervisor)
- The **Access Code** for the study (given to you by your supervisor)

- A phone with a web browser (Chrome or Safari) and, just for the very first setup, mobile data or wifi
- Signed paper consent forms and Participant Information Sheets, as per your normal fieldwork procedure

Privacy reminder

Do not type a participant's name, phone number, Facebook username, profile link, password, private messages, or exact home address into the app at any point. The questionnaire is designed to need none of this — if a question ever seems to ask for it, skip it and continue.

3. One-time setup (needs internet)

Do this once per phone, before your first day of fieldwork — you won't need to repeat it.

- 1 Open your browser and go to the web address your supervisor gave you.
- 2 Tap the survey you'll be collecting for.
- 3 Enter the **Access Code** and your **Student Researcher ID** exactly as given to you, then tap **Continue**.
- 4 Recommended: use your browser's "Add to Home Screen" option so the app opens like a normal app and reminds you it's there.

"Student researcher ID not recognised"

Double-check spelling and capitalisation with your supervisor — IDs are matched exactly. If it still doesn't work, contact your supervisor before continuing.

4. Collecting a response

Repeat this for every participant you interview:

- 1 Confirm the participant has read the Participant Information Sheet and signed the paper consent form, as per your normal fieldwork procedure.
- 2 Open the survey in the app and work through each section, tapping the answer that best matches what the participant tells you.
- 3 Tap **Next** to move to the next section. Required questions are marked with a red asterisk (*) and must be answered before you can continue.
- 4 On the last section, tap **Submit**.
- 5 Tap **Start next participant** to reset the form and begin the next interview.

A participant may be screened out — this is normal

The first few questions check whether someone is eligible (18+, uses Facebook, lives/works/studies in Honiara, and has agreed to take part). If they answer "No" to any of these, the app will end the survey automatically and show a thank-you message. This is expected — simply thank the person and move on to your next participant. It still counts as a recorded attempt.

5. Working without signal

A small bar at the top of the screen shows your connection status and how many completed responses are still waiting to be sent:

- **Online** (green dot) — responses are sending automatically.
- **Offline — saving locally** (amber dot) — keep working normally. Nothing is lost; it will send itself once you're back in signal.
- A number like **“3 waiting to sync”** means 3 completed responses are stored on your phone, ready to send.

At the end of each day

Open the app once while you have signal (e.g. back at your accommodation) and check the status bar shows “0 waiting to sync” before you close it for the night. You can also tap **Sync now** to force it to try immediately.

6. Checking your progress

You are asked to collect **10 completed responses**. Tap **My progress** — always visible next to the sync status at the top of the screen — at any point to see how you're doing.

The screenshot shows the Survey Shark app interface. At the top, there's a status bar with a green dot and the word 'Online'. To the right of the status bar is a link labeled 'My progress'. Below the status bar, a progress bar indicates 'Section 1 of 9' and '11%'. The main content area is titled 'Collection Details' and contains the following fields:

- Participant code ***: A text input field containing 'DEMO-001-8LNU'.
- Student researcher ID ***: A text input field containing 'DEMO-001'.
- Date of survey ***: A date picker showing '2026-09-24'.
- General collection area ***: A group of four radio button options: 'Honiara East', 'Honiara Central', 'Honiara West', and 'Other approved location'.
- Mode of completion ***: A group of three radio button options: 'Participant completed independently', 'Researcher read the questions to the participant', and 'Other approved method'.

At the bottom of the form, there are two buttons: 'Back' and 'Next'.

“My progress” is always visible while you're filling in a survey.

This opens your own dashboard: how many completed responses you have out of your target of 10, how many were screened out, and your most recent participants.

My progress

2 of 10 completed
8 more to go

Screened out (ineligible participants)
1

Recent activity
Tap any row to see the full answers you recorded.

DEMO-001-EF56	24/09/2026	Screened out
DEMO-001-CD34	24/09/2026	Completed
DEMO-001-AB12	24/09/2026	Completed

Your progress dashboard — completed count, screened-out count, and recent activity.

Tap any row under **Recent activity** to see every answer you recorded for that participant — useful for double-checking your own work, or if your supervisor asks about a specific interview.

[← Back to my progress](#)

DEMO-001-CD34
24/09/2026, 12:15:16 Completed

Collection Details

General collection area Honiara West	Mode of completion Researcher read the questions to the participant
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Section A: Eligibility

Are you 18 years of age or older? Yes	Do you currently use Facebook? Yes
Do you currently live, work or study in Honiara? Yes	Have you received the Participant Information Sheet and freely agreed to participate? Yes

Section B: General Information

What is your age group? 18–24 years	How do you describe your gender? Male
What is your current main activity? Student	Which statement best describes your connection to Honiara? I study in Honiara, I live in Honiara

Section C: General Facebook Use

For approximately how long have you used Facebook? 6–10 years	How often do you normally use Facebook? Almost constantly throughout the day
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Tapping a past participant shows everything you recorded for them.

Works offline too

If you filled it in on this phone, tapping a past response opens instantly — no signal needed, since the full answers are already saved on the device. A response can only fail to open if it was collected on a different device and you don't currently have signal.

7. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
"Incorrect access code"	Re-check the code with your supervisor — it is case-sensitive.
"Student researcher ID not recognised"	Confirm the exact spelling/format of your ID with your supervisor.
App looks blank or stuck	Close and reopen the browser tab. You only need signal for the very first setup, not for collecting responses.
Accidentally closed the app mid-survey	The in-progress (unsubmitted) response is lost. Start that participant again from the beginning — already-submitted responses are unaffected.
Not sure if a response actually saved	Check the sync status bar at the top of the screen — it shows how many are waiting or already synced.
A past response won't open	It was likely collected on a different device — you'll need signal to load it from the server.
Anything else	Contact your supervisor using the details on the front page of this guide.

Tagio tumas — thank you for helping with this research.